

COVER STORY **INDO-US TRADE**

TRUMPING TRUMP

Donald Trump is a walking, talking, known unknown—as everybody knows. His tariff war was always expected, but his blitzkrieg on the world order still took most of us by surprise. As global markets, governments and policymakers take stock of the debris of globalisation he has left in his protectionist wake, we asked a panel of experts to assess what India could salvage from the situation. While the equation for America's 'reciprocal tariffs' is less algebra than abracadabra, there is also a clear intent behind the alternative facts that drive Trumpian policy. India's position is more ambiguous than most, as our writers point out, and a strategy of *ahimsa* rather than retaliation seems the better part of valour. As ever, there are opportunities in this crisis—and not just for India. Could Trump's gamble be China's or even Europe's moment? Or are we already witnessing a conciliatory climbdown in the name of the art of the deal? India will clearly have to hedge its bets and prioritise situational awareness in the dynamic disruption of the new world system. In the following pages, five leading experts spell out some of the ways India can trim its sails to ride out the tariff tsunami.

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